Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud via Screen Sharing

UPI fraud has become increasingly common, heavily targeting college students who frequently use digital transactions. In a typical scenario, a student lists an item for sale online. A fraudster poses as a buyer, agreeing to the price quickly. To execute the fraud, the "buyer" claims they are facing a network issue and asks the student to download a screen-sharing application to help troubleshoot the transaction. Once access is granted, the fraudster sends a payment link, falsely claiming it is to *send* the funds to the student. When the student opens their UPI app and enters their UPI PIN—believing they are completing a receipt process—the fraudster captures the PIN. The attacker then quickly initiates unauthorized transactions. The consequences are immediate financial loss, highlighting that cybercrime often relies heavily on social engineering.

PREVENTION CHECKLIST

1. Never share OTPs with anyone under any circumstances.

2. **UPI Safety:** Remember that a UPI PIN is only required to *send* money, never to *receive* it.

3. **Financial Safety:** Do not download screen-sharing apps (like AnyDesk) if asked by an unknown buyer/seller.

4.Verify links before clicking by hovering over them.

5. Use Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all primary accounts.

6. Keep software and antivirus programs updated.

7.Avoid logging into banking apps on public Wi-Fi networks.

8. Report incidents immediately to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or call Helpline 1930.